

SSKZM OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION

Part I

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

for

Conduct of Elections to the Executive Committee

Part II

SSKZM OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION

BYLAWS – ARTICLE IV SECTION 1A

Proposed Sub Section (iii) - Elections

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Preamble

P.1 Authority

This Standard Operating Procedure is issued under the authority of the Bylaws of the SSKZM Old Boys Association, Article IV, as amended at the Annual General Body Meeting held on 20 July 2024, and the Annual General Body Meeting held on 19 July 2025, for the purpose of laying down detailed guidelines for conduct of elections to the Executive Committee of SSKZM OBA.

P.2 Scope

This SOP governs the conduct of all elections to the Executive Committee of the SSKZM Old Boys Association, including annual elections held at the Annual General Body Meeting and by-elections held to fill mid-term vacancies. It applies to elections conducted in physical mode, electronic mode, and hybrid mode. All posts of the Executive Committee as constituted from time to time are covered.

P.3 Edition Note

This is the first edition of this SOP. The process described herein applies equally to physical elections, with the only difference being the voting mechanism and the voting date, as described in Chapter 7. This SOP shall be reviewed after the first election conducted under it and updated as required. Where this SOP is silent on any matter, the Bylaws of the Association shall prevail.

P.4 Relationship to Bylaws

This SOP operationalises the Bylaws of the Association. It does not override them. In the event of any conflict between this SOP and the Bylaws, the Bylaws shall prevail. Terms used in this SOP have the same meaning as in the Bylaws unless otherwise specified. A Glossary of terms is at Appendix G.

Chapter 1 — Election Calendar

1.1 AGM Deadline

The Annual General Body Meeting shall be held not later than the 30th of September each year, in accordance with the Bylaws of the Association as amended at the Annual General Body Meeting held on 19 July 2025.

1.2 Minimum Timelines

The following minimum periods shall be observed in every election. The Returning Officer may allow longer periods at their discretion but shall not shorten any of these minimum periods except as permitted under Section 1.5.

- Cutoff date for Life Membership inclusion in voter roll: not later than V-47.
- EC to ascertain willingness of eligible Life Members to perform the role of RO: not less than 47 days before AGM.
- Panel of fifteen senior-most willing eligible Life Members for RO to be published: not less than 45 days before AGM.
- Objection window on panel: 5 days from date of publication.
- RO formally appointed and communicated to all members: within 2 days of close of objection window.
- Appeals Panel constituted by the Executive Committee: simultaneously with the RO appointment communication.
- Technical Election Manager (TEM): appointed by RO if deemed necessary. Where appointed, communicated to all members simultaneously with or within 2 days of RO appointment; 3-day objection window. Where not appointed, RO records declaration in AdminLog before nomination window opens. Nomination window need not await TEM appointment or objection window.
- Nomination window: minimum 14 days — Phase 1 (7 days) followed immediately by Phase 2 (7 days). Both phases open for all posts unconditionally.
- Scrutiny period: minimum 5 days from close of nominations (compressible to 3 days under stage compression — see Section 1.5).
- Final candidate list publication: not less than 3 days before opening of voting window.
- Candidature withdrawal deadline: end of day on the day following publication of the final candidate list (D+1 from publication).
- Voting window: minimum 7 days (compressible to 5 days under stage compression — see Section 1.5), opening not earlier than 72 hours after publication of the final candidate list and closing not later than the date required to allow results to be declared not less than 7 days before AGM day (electronic elections), subject to any extensions under Section 1.5 or Section 7.6, in which case the provisions of Section 2.6 shall apply. The voting window close date is set by the RO.
- Notice to all members for AGM: minimum 14 days, per Article IV Section 2 of the Bylaws.
- Election record filing: the RO shall file the complete election record and surrender all credentials to the incoming EC on the day the election period concludes.

1.3 Model Election Calendar

A worked example of all key dates calculated back from V-day (the AGM date) is at Appendix A. This shall be adapted with actual dates for each election and published to all members as part of the election schedule. For electronic elections, results are declared at V-7; the formal announcement and EC handover take place at V-0 (AGM day).

1.4 Election Schedule

The Executive Committee shall prepare a framework election schedule before the commencement of the panel publication process. The Returning Officer shall finalise and publish the election schedule upon appointment, incorporating all key dates listed in Section 1.2. Any revision to the schedule after publication shall be communicated to all members immediately, with reasons.

1.5 Extension Provisions and Stage Compression

The Returning Officer may extend any phase by 2 to 7 days on account of technical interruption, insufficient nominations, or other cause recorded in writing and communicated to all members. Extensions beyond seven days in total for any one phase require the approval of the Executive Committee. No extension shall be granted after the voting window has opened, except in the event of a technical interruption affecting the voting platform, in which case Section 7.6 shall apply. The extension provisions for the nomination phase are further described in Section 4.9.

Stage compression is permitted where time has been lost to extensions and it is necessary to complete the election before AGM day: the scrutiny period may be compressed to a minimum of 3 days and the voting window to a minimum of 5 days. The RO shall record the reason for any compression in the AdminLog and communicate it to all members immediately. No compression is permitted once the voting window has opened. Constitutional objection windows may not be compressed under any circumstance.

1.6 Digital Authentication and Remote Participation

The SSKZM OBA membership is geographically dispersed across India and internationally. All processes under this SOP — including RO selection, panel objections, voter roll objections, nominations, scrutiny queries, appeals, and voting — shall be conducted through authenticated digital means, with provision for physical participation where necessary. No member shall be disadvantaged on account of physical location.

Chapter 2 — Returning Officer

2.1 Constitutional Basis

The Returning Officer is the constitutional authority for the conduct of elections to the Executive Committee. The powers and duties of the Returning Officer are governed by Article IV of the Bylaws of the Association and these Operating Procedures. This SOP operationalises those provisions.

2.2 RO Eligibility

The Returning Officer shall be a Life Member of the Association who satisfies all of the following conditions:

- Is not contesting any post in the election for which they are appointed.
- Is not a member of the current Executive Committee.
- Is willing to serve in the capacity of Returning Officer for the duration of the election process.

2.3 RO Selection — Panel with Objection Window

Not less than 47 days before the Annual General Body Meeting, the Executive Committee shall ascertain the willingness of Life Members in order of seniority, determined by batch and roll number, to serve as Returning Officer. Not less than 45 days before the Annual General Body Meeting, the Executive Committee shall publish a panel comprising the fifteen senior-most Life Members who are willing to serve and satisfy the eligibility conditions in Section 2.2 above.

Any Life Member of the Association may raise a written objection to the inclusion of any panel member within five days of publication of the panel. Objections shall be addressed in writing to the Executive Committee and shall state the grounds for objection with sufficient particularity. The Executive Committee shall consider all objections received and determine whether each objection is valid. The Returning Officer shall be the senior-most panel member against whom no valid objection stands at the close of the objection window.

If all panel members are the subject of valid objections, a new panel of the next fifteen willing eligible Life Members in order of seniority shall be published and the same process shall apply. The Executive Committee shall continue this process until the role is filled.

2.4 Formal Appointment and Commencement of Authority

Upon the close of the objection window, the Executive Committee shall communicate the appointment of the Returning Officer to all members of the Association. The Returning Officer's authority shall commence from the date of such communication. From this date, the Returning Officer shall function with full constitutional authority over the election process. At the commencement of the Annual General Body Meeting, the Returning Officer shall be acknowledged and shall thereafter declare the results of the election. This sequence applies identically to both physical and electronic elections.

2.5 Election Period — Authority and Continuity

The decision of the Returning Officer on all matters relating to the conduct of the election shall be final during the election period. The election period commences on the date of the Returning Officer's appointment and concludes on the day the incoming Executive Committee takes charge. The President of the Association shall assist the Returning Officer if so requested, provided the President is not seeking re-election.

Where the voting window cannot be closed by AGM day due to mandatory posts not being nominated, technical interruption or other contingency, the election period shall extend until the voting window is closed, results are declared, and the incoming Executive Committee takes charge. The Returning Officer's authority shall continue for the full duration of the extended period. The outgoing Executive Committee shall continue in a caretaker capacity with powers as specified by the General Body until the incoming Executive Committee takes

charge, which shall be at the earliest practicable time at a meeting convened by the outgoing Executive Committee for the purpose. The Returning Officer shall file the complete election record and surrender all credentials to the incoming Executive Committee on the day the incoming Executive Committee takes charge.

2.6 Conflict of Interest

The Returning Officer shall disclose any conflict of interest that arises after appointment immediately to the Executive Committee. The Executive Committee shall determine the appropriate course of action, which may include appointment of a substitute from the published panel.

2.7 Handover to RO

The Executive Committee shall hand over to the Returning Officer, on or before the date of formal appointment, the following:

- The certified voter roll (or draft voter roll if certification is pending).
- The election schedule.
- Access credentials to the election management application.
- Names and contact details of Scrutineers appointed by the Executive Committee, and confirmation of their acceptance.
- Record of TEM appointment or non-appointment declaration.
- Contact details of the General Secretary for liaison.

This handover shall be documented in writing or by authenticated email and acknowledged by both parties. A template handover checklist is at Appendix D.

2.8 Handover from RO

On the day the election period concludes — being the day the incoming Executive Committee takes charge — the Returning Officer shall file with the incoming General Secretary the complete election record as described in Section 8.6, and shall simultaneously surrender all access credentials to the election management system to the incoming Executive Committee. The Returning Officer shall have no further access to the application after this date.

Chapter 2A — Deputy RO, Technical Election Manager, Scrutineers, and Observers

Deputy RO

2A.1 Appointment and Role

The Returning Officer may designate a Deputy Returning Officer from the published RO panel by written notice communicated to all members before the voting window opens. The Deputy RO may be activated only upon the Returning Officer's confirmed unavailability during the voting window, which must be established in writing or by authenticated communication to at least one Scrutineer. The Deputy RO may simultaneously be part of the Appeals Panel and act in that authority provided they are not called upon to perform duties of the RO. If their performance of duties as RO coincides with their performance of duties as part of the Appeals Panel, they shall recuse themselves from the Appeals Panel for the duration of such activation.

Before the voting window opens, the Returning Officer shall create a second RO_ADMIN account in the election management system for the Deputy RO. The credentials of this account shall be sealed — printed and placed in a sealed envelope held by the Returning Officer or by a named Scrutineer — and shall not be used unless and until activation is required.

Activation of the Deputy RO account shall be witnessed by at least one Scrutineer and shall be recorded in the AdminLog immediately upon activation. The Deputy RO shall operate under the same authority and constraints as the Returning Officer for the duration of their activation. The Deputy RO shall surrender all credentials to the Returning Officer within twenty-four hours of the RO's return or the close of the voting window, whichever is earlier.

The Deputy RO shall satisfy the same eligibility conditions as the Returning Officer — not contesting any post and having no conflict of interest with any candidate.

Technical Election Manager

2A.2 Role

The Technical Election Manager is responsible for the setup, operation, and maintenance of the election management application under the direction and written authorisation of the Returning Officer. The Technical Election Manager has no constitutional authority over the election. All decisions relating to the conduct of the election vest in the Returning Officer.

2A.3 Appointment

The Returning Officer may, if deemed necessary, appoint a Technical Election Manager to assist in administering the Election Management System. The TEM shall preferably be a Life Member of the Association. Where the Returning Officer determines that no suitable candidate is available from within the Association, the Returning Officer may appoint an external technical professional for the purpose. The remuneration of an external TEM, if any, shall be decided by the Executive Committee. Every office of the TEM is honorary where the appointee is a Life Member.

Where the Returning Officer elects not to appoint a TEM, the Returning Officer shall record that decision as a written declaration in the AdminLog before the nomination window opens. This entry is visible on the election status page. No member communication is required for non-appointment.

Where a TEM is appointed, the TEM shall have full access to the election management system at the same level as the Returning Officer, and shall operate solely under the written authorisation of the Returning Officer as described in Section 2A.6.

2A.4 Eligibility and Independence

The Technical Election Manager shall satisfy all of the following conditions:

- Is not contesting any post in the election.
- Is not a member of the current Executive Committee.
- Possesses sufficient technical competence to set up and operate the election management application.

Before assuming the role, the Technical Election Manager shall sign a declaration of impartiality and absence of conflict of interest. The form of this declaration is at Appendix E1. Where the TEM has system credentials, the system login and acceptance constitutes the declaration.

2A.5 Communication and Objection Window

Where the Returning Officer appoints a TEM, the proposed appointment shall be communicated to all members simultaneously with or within two days of the communication of the Returning Officer's appointment. Any Life Member may raise a written objection to the appointment within three days of such communication. The Returning Officer shall consider any objections received and confirm or revise the appointment accordingly.

2A.6 Duties and Mode of Operation of the TEM

The Technical Election Manager shall assist the Returning Officer in the operation of the Election Management System only upon the written authorisation of the Returning Officer recorded in the system. The TEM shall not perform any action in the system without a prior authorisation from the Returning Officer for that specific action.

Before the TEM performs any action, the Returning Officer shall record a written authorisation in the system using the RO authorisation function. The system generates a unique AuthorisationID for each authorisation and records it in the AdminLog with the Returning Officer's Admin ID, timestamp, and a description of the action authorised. The Returning Officer communicates the AuthorisationID to the TEM.

The TEM logs into the system using TEM-tier credentials, which carry the same access level as the Returning Officer's credentials and performs only the specific action described in the authorisation, quoting the AuthorisationID in the action record. All actions performed by the TEM are logged to the AdminLog under the TEM's identity with the AuthorisationID as reference. The Returning Officer retains full visibility of all TEM actions through the AdminLog at all times.

For exceptional actions outside normal election workflow, the Returning Officer may additionally record the authorisation by authenticated email, a copy of which the TEM uploads to the document store before executing the action. This supplementary record does not replace the in-system authorisation but provides an additional audit trail for actions of significance.

The Returning Officer may revoke TEM access credentials at any moment. Revocation is recorded in the AdminLog immediately.

Scrutineers

2A.7 Appointment

The Executive Committee shall appoint not less than two and not more than four Scrutineers. Scrutineers shall be Life Members of the Association who are not contesting any post and are not members of the current Executive Committee. The Executive Committee shall endeavour to ensure that Scrutineers represent a cross-section of batch groups. The Executive Committee shall appoint Scrutineers simultaneously with or within two days of constituting the Appeals Panel. The General Secretary shall communicate each appointment to the Scrutineer concerned and to the Returning Officer.

Upon receiving the appointment communication, the Returning Officer shall enter the Scrutineer's details in the election management system, which shall send a digital acceptance link to the Scrutineer. The Scrutineer's acceptance through the system shall constitute the Scrutineer's Declaration of Impartiality (Appendix E2). The system shall notify

the General Secretary and the Returning Officer of each acceptance and shall activate the Scrutineer's credentials on acceptance. Non-acceptance within the period specified in the appointment communication shall trigger a system alert to the General Secretary and Returning Officer for replacement.

Scrutineers shall have full read-only access to the AdminLog from the date of their appointment through the Scrutineer panel in the election management system, so as to be able to independently verify all significant system actions recorded during the election period.

2A.8 Duties of Scrutineers

The duties of the Scrutineers are as follows:

- To witness and confirm, before the voting window opens, that the data protection measures have been applied to the election management system and that the version of the system deployed is as declared by the Returning Officer.
- To verify that the count of votes cast tallies with the count of voters recorded as having participated, for each post.
- To witness the vote tally for each post and satisfy themselves as to its correctness.
- To witness any draw of lots conducted in the event of a tie between candidates.
- To co-sign the tally sheet through the system's tally co-sign function before the Returning Officer declares results. Physical co-signature on a printed tally sheet is also permitted as a supplementary act.
- To have read-only access to the full AdminLog at all times from the date of appointment, through the Scrutineer panel in the election management system.

2A.9 Powers and Limitations of Scrutineers

Scrutineers may record their observations in writing to the Returning Officer at any time during the election period. The Returning Officer shall consider such observations and communicate a response. Scrutineers shall have no power to override the decisions of the Returning Officer.

Observers

2A.10 Appointment

The Returning Officer may accredit Observers for the election. Observers may include representatives nominated by contesting candidates. Candidates wishing to nominate an Observer shall communicate the name and Roll No of the proposed Observer to the Returning Officer not less than three days before the opening of the voting window.

2A.11 Role and Access of Observers

Observers shall have access to aggregate participation data — the number of votes cast per post in real time — through the Observer dashboard in the election management system. Observers shall have no access to individual voter information or to vote distribution between candidates. Observers may attend the tally session and record their observations in writing. Observer access is active only during the voting window.

Appeals Panel

2A.12 Constitution and Role of the Appeals Panel

The Executive Committee shall constitute an Appeals Panel drawn from the panel published for RO selection, in order of seniority. The Appeals Panel shall comprise an odd number of members, being not less than three. The most senior member shall be Chair. The Executive Committee shall constitute the Appeals Panel simultaneously with the Scrutineer appointments.

The Appeals Panel shall hear appeals against nomination rejections and against decisions or sanctions imposed in the conduct of the election. Any candidate or member directly affected by a decision or sanction may file a written appeal to the Chair within 48 hours of receipt of the decision. The Panel shall decide within 48 hours of receipt of the appeal by simple majority, with any dissent recorded. The decision of the Appeals Panel shall be final for the purposes of the current election.

Nothing in this section shall prejudice the right of any member to raise a governance grievance with the General Body.

A member of the Appeals Panel who is simultaneously designated as Deputy Returning Officer shall continue on the Appeals Panel unless and until activated as Deputy Returning Officer, at which point they shall recuse themselves for the duration of activation and another eligible member from the panel shall replace them. This action shall be reversed on completion of performance of duties of RO by the Deputy RO.

Chapter 3 — Voter Roll

3.1 Eligibility

Only Life Members of the Association are entitled to vote in elections to the Executive Committee. Annual Members and Honorary Members are explicitly excluded from voting. This is in accordance with Article II Section 2 of the Bylaws of the Association.

3.2 Preparation of Draft Voter Roll

The office bearers of the Association shall prepare a draft voter roll comprising all Life Members of the Association as on the cutoff date. The cutoff date shall be declared by the Executive Committee as part of the election schedule and shall not be later than the date on which the Executive Committee commences the process of ascertaining the willingness of eligible Life Members for RO, being not less than 47 days before the Annual General Body Meeting. No Life Memberships admitted after the cutoff date shall be included in the voter roll for that election. The draft voter roll shall include, for each voter, the Roll No, full name, and batch. It shall also include the registered email address for internal use, which shall not be published.

3.3 Email Verification

Before handing the draft voter roll to the Returning Officer, the office bearers shall cause a verification email to be sent to every email address on the draft voter roll. An email verification tool is available on the election landing page for this purpose. This tool is accessible to the Executive Committee and batch representatives only, and is automatically disabled at the time of handover to the Returning Officer.

The verification exercise is a quality check on the registered email addresses in the voter roll. It is not a re-registration of membership. A Life Member's entitlement to vote derives from their Life Membership status as on the cutoff date and not from their response to the verification email. The draft voter roll shall include all Life Members as on the cutoff date regardless of whether they respond to the verification email.

The verification exercise shall produce three categories of outcome for each voter record:

Category 1 — **Verified**: The verification email was delivered and the member responded confirming their details. No further action required for this record.

Category 2 — **Unresponsive**: The verification email was delivered to the registered address but the member did not respond within the notice period of ten days from the date of sending. The member remains on the draft voter roll. Their registered email address is treated as current. Their silence does not affect their inclusion in the voter roll. The system's delivery record for this address is part of the election record.

Category 3 — **Undeliverable**: Where a voter's registered email address is undeliverable, the batch representative for that voter's batch shall be notified and shall attempt to obtain the correct email address within the period available before handover to the Returning Officer. Where the matter remains unresolved at the time of handover, it shall be referred to the Returning Officer for a decision on inclusion or exclusion from the certified voter roll.

For each Category 3 member where a correct email address is ascertained and verified, the record shall be updated before handover. For each Category 3 member where a correct email address cannot be ascertained before handover, the member's record shall be flagged as unverified email and handed to the Returning Officer with a note. The Returning Officer shall retain the flagged record on the draft voter roll so that the member has the opportunity to raise an objection during the objection window under Section 3.5.

The office bearers shall prepare a verification summary for the Returning Officer at the time of handover, listing the total number of voters, the number in each category, and the details of all Category 3 cases including the steps taken and the outcome.

A member who believes their registered email address is incorrect or has changed shall notify the office bearers before the voter roll is handed to the Returning Officer. Notifications received after handover shall be directed to the Returning Officer, who shall treat them as objections under Section 3.5.

3.4 Publication of Draft Voter Roll

The Returning Officer shall publish the draft voter roll to all members of the Association. The published roll shall include all Life Members as on the cutoff date, regardless of the outcome of the email verification exercise. The publication shall include, for each voter, their Roll No, full name, and batch. Email addresses shall not be published.

A minimum objection window of seven days shall be provided from the date of publication. The purpose of the objection window is to give every member the opportunity to verify their own inclusion in the roll and to raise any concern about inclusion or exclusion before the roll is certified. Publication of the draft voter roll and the objection window together constitute the primary safeguard against errors of inclusion and exclusion.

The Returning Officer shall communicate the fact of publication and the objection window clearly to all members, specifying the last date and time for receipt of objections and the address to which objections shall be sent.

3.5 Objections to Voter Roll

Any Life Member of the Association may raise a written objection to the inclusion or exclusion of any person in the draft voter roll within the objection window. Objections shall be addressed to the Returning Officer and shall state the grounds with sufficient particularity.

A member who finds themselves excluded from the draft voter roll shall raise an objection during this window. The objection window is the constitutional remedy for errors of exclusion. A member who is excluded from the draft voter roll and does not raise an objection during the objection window may not claim non-inclusion after the voter roll is certified.

The Returning Officer shall consider all objections received and make such additions, deletions, or corrections as are warranted. The Returning Officer shall communicate the decision on each objection in writing to the member who raised it, stating reasons. All objections received, the decisions made, and the reasons shall be recorded by the Returning Officer and shall form part of the election record.

3.6 Certification of Voter Roll

The Returning Officer shall certify the final voter roll not less than 24 days before the Annual General Body Meeting. Before certifying, the Returning Officer shall satisfy themselves that all objections received during the objection window have been disposed of, and that the voter roll as it stands is a complete and accurate record of Life Members of the Association as on the cutoff date to the best of the Association's knowledge.

No additions, deletions, or corrections shall be made to the certified voter roll after the date of certification under any circumstance whatsoever.

A member who received the verification email under Section 3.3 but did not respond, and who did not raise an objection during the objection window under Section 3.5, is deemed to have confirmed their registration by their conduct. No claim of error in inclusion or exclusion on this ground will be entertained after the voter roll is certified.

A member who was on the certified voter roll but was unable to cast their vote because their registered email address was incorrect or inactive — and who did not take steps to correct it

before certification despite having had the opportunity to do so — has no claim against the validity of the election on this ground. The responsibility for maintaining a current registered email address with the Association rests with the member.

The system's delivery records from the email verification exercise are part of the election record and are the documentary evidence of the steps taken to verify each email address. These records shall be exported by the RO and filed with the election record at the close of the election.

3.7 Loading the Certified Voter Roll into the System

After certification, the RO shall upload the certified voter roll into the Voters tab of the election management system using the voter roll upload function in the admin panel. The upload replaces any existing data in the Voters tab. The RO shall verify, after upload, that the row count in the system matches the number of voters on the certified voter roll signed by the RO.

The upload shall not take place before the RO has signed the certification. The RO shall record this confirmation in the election record.

No voter may be added to, deleted from, or modified in the Voters tab after the certified voter roll has been uploaded, except by written authorisation of the RO.

Chapter 4 — Nominations

4.1 Candidate Eligibility

The eligibility conditions for each post are as follows. A candidate who does not satisfy the eligibility conditions for the post sought shall not be placed on the ballot.

President (as per bylaw amendment dated 20 July 2024):

A candidate for the post of President must satisfy either Rule P-A or Rule P-B below, depending on their EC service history.

Rule P-A — Standard pathway: Applies to all alumni who have not served as Ex-officio member of the EC. The candidate must have held one or more of the following EC posts for a cumulative total of at least two years at any time during the preceding fifteen years: President, Vice President, General Secretary, Joint Secretary, or Treasurer. Service as Batch Representative does not count under this rule.

Rule P-B — Ex-officio pathway: Applies only to alumni who have also served as Ex-officio member of the EC. The candidate must have held one or more of the following EC posts for a cumulative total of at least two years at any time during the preceding fifteen years: President, Vice President, General Secretary, Joint Secretary, Treasurer, or Batch Representative. Service as Batch Representative counts as qualifying service under this rule. Ex-officio service itself does not count toward the two-year qualifying period under either rule.

General Secretary: Must have been a member of the Executive Committee in any capacity, including as a Batch Representative or co-opted member, for at least one year at any time during the preceding fifteen years.

Consecutive Tenure Bar: Any member who has held any EC post, excluding Batch Representative, for six consecutive years shall not be eligible to stand for election to any EC post, unless they have not held any post in the EC in the preceding two years. An absence of only one year alone from the EC in the preceding six years shall not be counted as a break in EC tenure.

Organising Secretary: Preferably from the batch organising the succeeding reunion as designated by the Returning Officer. Maximum tenure five years.

Batch Representatives: The candidate shall belong to the batch group for which nomination is submitted. Only Life Members belonging to the designated batch group may vote for that Batch Representative post.

All other posts: Life Member of the Association. The consecutive tenure bar applies.

4.1A One Post Per Person

A member may not contest more than one post in any election. Where a member has an existing nomination in accepted or confirmed status for any post in the same election, a further nomination for any other post shall not be accepted. Where a member has given consent to a nomination for any post, consent to a nomination for any other post in the same election shall not be accepted. A member wishing to contest a different post shall withdraw their existing nomination before submitting or consenting to a new one.

4.1B Multi-Seat Posts

The posts of Vice President and Joint Secretary are each constituted as multi-seat posts with two seats apiece. For the purposes of nominations, scrutiny, the ballot, and the declaration of results, these posts shall each be treated as a single ballot item. Candidates for Vice President nominate for the post of **Vice President**; candidates for Joint Secretary nominate for the post of **Joint Secretary**. There is no separate nomination for Vice President 1, Vice President 2, Joint Secretary 1, or Joint Secretary 2.

Each voter shall have one vote per multi-seat post. The two candidates receiving the highest number of votes for the post of Vice President shall be elected as Vice Presidents. The two candidates receiving the highest number of votes for the post of Joint Secretary shall be elected as Joint Secretaries. NOTA votes cast for a multi-seat post count against all candidates in that post. In the event of a tie for the final seat, the Returning Officer shall conduct a draw of lots in the presence of the Scrutineers. The designation of Vice President 1 and Vice President 2, and Joint Secretary 1 and Joint Secretary 2, among the elected members shall be by inter-se seniority in accordance with the Bylaws of the Association.

4.2 Nomination Call

The Returning Officer shall issue a notification calling for nominations to all posts of the Executive Committee. The notification shall specify the opening and closing dates for nominations, the eligibility conditions for each post, the minimum required posts list under Section 4.10, and the designated batch for Organising Secretary under Section 4.11. The nomination window shall remain open for a minimum of 14 days, comprising Phase 1 (7 days) followed immediately by Phase 2 (7 days). Both phases are open for all posts unconditionally. The notification shall include the prescribed nomination form.

4.3 Nomination Form — Phase 1

Each Phase 1 nomination shall be submitted through the online nomination form in the election management system, or through such other channel as specified in the nomination call. The form shall contain the following fields:

- Full name of the candidate, Roll No, and batch.
- Post for which nomination is submitted.
- Declaration by the candidate of eligibility for the post, including confirmation that the tenure bars described in Section 4.1 do not apply.
- Full name and Roll No of the proposer, and the proposer's electronic confirmation.
- Full name and Roll No of the seconder, and the seconder's electronic confirmation.
- Electronic confirmation of the candidate.

Both the proposer and the seconder shall be Life Members of the Association. The system validates the roll numbers of the candidate, proposer, and seconder against the certified voter roll at the time of submission and will not accept a nomination where any of the three roll numbers is not found on the voter roll. A candidate may not be their own proposer or seconder. A person may not propose or second more than one candidate for the same post.

Upon submission, the system sends automatic confirmation emails to both the proposer and the seconder at their registered addresses, each containing a secure one-click confirmation link. A nomination is not complete until both the proposer and the seconder have confirmed through their respective links. The candidate may monitor the confirmation status of their proposer and seconder in real time through the My Nominations dashboard. Confirmation links expire at the nomination deadline. A nomination for which either the proposer or seconder confirmation has not been received by the nomination deadline shall be treated as incomplete and shall not proceed to scrutiny.

Where a proposer or seconder has not received or has lost their confirmation email, the Returning Officer may resend the confirmation link to the member's registered email

address, or generate a secure link for delivery via an alternative channel. In either case a new one-time token is generated and the previous token is invalidated. The action is logged to AdminLog. The member must still confirm through the secure link by entering their roll number — the Returning Officer cannot confirm on behalf of a member.

4.3A Nomination Visibility During Nomination Window

Confirmed nominations — being nominations for which the proposer and seconder have both confirmed through the system — shall be visible to all voters through the election management system from the time of confirmation throughout the nomination window and the scrutiny period. The display shall show the candidate's name, roll number, batch, and the post for which nomination has been submitted. It shall not show proposer or seconder details. A disclaimer shall be displayed alongside the nominations list stating that these are nominations submitted for scrutiny and are not confirmed candidates — the final candidate list shall be published upon completion of scrutiny.

4.4 Submission and Acknowledgement

Nominations shall be submitted through the online nomination form in the election management system, or through such other channel as specified by the Returning Officer in the nomination call. The system shall issue an automatic acknowledgement for each nomination received, with a unique reference number. For nominations submitted through other channels, the Returning Officer shall issue an acknowledgement manually. The acknowledgement shall not constitute acceptance of the nomination.

4.5 Withdrawal

A candidate may withdraw their nomination at any stage up to and including the candidature withdrawal deadline, being end of day on the day following the publication of the final candidate list (D+1 from publication). The voting window shall not open earlier than 72 hours after publication of the final candidate list. No withdrawal shall be accepted after the candidature withdrawal deadline under any circumstance. A candidate who withdraws shall communicate this to their proposer and seconder as a matter of courtesy. The system records the withdrawal with a timestamp in the Nominations tab and the ScrutinyLog.

4.6 Scrutiny Applies to All Nominations

Every nomination received, regardless of the phase in which it was submitted or the method through which it was submitted, is subject to scrutiny by the Returning Officer before the candidate may appear on the ballot. There is no category of nomination that bypasses scrutiny. The scrutiny procedure is set out in Chapter 5. This includes nominations entered manually by the Returning Officer under Section 4.8.

4.7 Phase 2 — Open Nominations

Phase 2 nominations open immediately upon the close of Phase 1 for all posts unconditionally. The Returning Officer shall communicate the opening of Phase 2 to all members at the close of Phase 1.

Phase 2 nominations differ from Phase 1 nominations in the following respects:

Nominator as proposer: In Phase 2, any Life Member may nominate a candidate for any post. The nominator is automatically recorded as the proposer. The nominator may not be the candidate themselves.

Candidate consent: A Phase 2 nomination is submitted by the nominator on behalf of the proposed candidate. The system sends an automatic consent request email to the proposed candidate immediately on submission. The candidate has 48 hours from the time of the consent request to accept or decline. If the candidate accepts, the nomination proceeds. If the candidate declines, or does not respond within 48 hours, the nomination lapses.

immediately. The nominator is notified. A fresh nomination of a different candidate for the same post remains possible within the Phase 2 window.

Secunder: A seconder is required for a Phase 2 nomination but may be added after the candidate's consent is received. A nomination for which seconder confirmation has not been received by the close of the Phase 2 window shall be treated as incomplete and shall not proceed to scrutiny.

Duplicate nominations: If a candidate has already accepted consent for a nomination for the same post in the same election, the system shall block a further Phase 2 nomination of the same candidate for the same post. If a nomination for the same candidate for the same post is pending consent, the system shall allow submission but shall warn the nominator that a consent is already pending.

Scrutiny: All Phase 2 nominations that are complete at the close of the Phase 2 window shall proceed to scrutiny under Chapter 5 in the same manner as Phase 1 nominations.

4.8 RO Manual Nomination Entry

The Returning Officer may enter a nomination manually through the admin panel where a candidate is unable to submit through the online form and has submitted a signed physical nomination form. Manual entry shall not be used to bypass any requirement of the nomination process. The Returning Officer shall ensure that all fields are complete and that the proposer and seconder have confirmed their consent before manual entry is processed.

For RO manual entries, three documents shall be uploaded to the election document store before the entry is accepted by the system: the signed nomination form, the proposer's confirmation, and the seconder's confirmation. The upload reference is recorded in the nomination record and in the AdminLog.

4.9 Nomination Extension Mechanism

Where one or more of the mandatory posts — President, Vice President, General Secretary, Treasurer — has no complete and valid nomination after the close of the nomination window, the Returning Officer shall trigger a further extension of 2 to 7 days. This extension shall continue in 2 to 7 day increments for as long as any mandatory post remains without a nomination, with no cap on the number of extensions. The Returning Officer shall communicate each extension to all members immediately with reasons.

The voting window shall not open until all mandatory posts have at least one accepted nomination each on the final candidate list. The election may proceed without a mandatory post being filled only upon approval of the General Body.

4.10 Minimum Posts Threshold

Before the nomination window opens, the Returning Officer shall configure the minimum required posts list in the election management system. This list shall always include the following mandatory posts: President, Vice President, General Secretary, and Treasurer. These posts may not be removed from the minimum required posts list under any circumstance. The Returning Officer may add further posts to the list at their discretion. The list shall be communicated to all members as part of the nomination call.

The election management system shall not permit the voting window to be opened while any post on the mandatory required posts list remains without an accepted nomination. The hard-block for the mandatory posts is lifted only where the Returning Officer has recorded a General Body approval authorising the election to proceed without that post. No discretionary Returning Officer override of the mandatory posts hard-block is available without a recorded General Body approval.

4.11 Organising Secretary — Designated Batch Procedure

The Returning Officer shall specify the designated batch for the post of Organising Secretary before the nomination window opens. The designated batch shall be recorded in the election configuration in the system and communicated to all members in the nomination call.

If at least one valid and complete nomination is received from a candidate belonging to the designated batch, the post of Organising Secretary shall be treated as a batch-restricted post for the purposes of voter eligibility.

If no valid and complete nomination is received from a candidate belonging to the designated batch by the close of phase one of the nomination window, the Returning Officer shall declare the post open to all Life Members. The RO shall communicate this change of status to all members immediately.

4.12 Relationship Between Nomination Phases — Summary

Phase 1 opens on the date specified in the nomination call and remains open for 7 days. Phase 2 opens immediately upon the close of Phase 1 for all posts unconditionally and remains open for 7 days. The total nomination window is 14 days.

After Phase 2 closes — or after any extension under Section 4.9 — the Returning Officer shall review all complete and valid nominations across both phases. All such nominations proceed to scrutiny under Chapter 5 regardless of the phase in which they were received. No nomination may appear on the ballot without having been accepted by the Returning Officer after scrutiny.

4.13 My Nominations Dashboard

Every candidate who has submitted a nomination, or in whose name a nomination has been submitted, may view the current status of their nomination at any time through the My Nominations dashboard in the election management system. The dashboard shows the nomination reference number, the post for which nomination was submitted, the confirmation status of the proposer and seconder, for Phase 2 nominations the consent status, and the current scrutiny status. The rejection reason is shown if the nomination has been rejected. The dashboard is read-only. Withdrawal through the dashboard is available under Section 4.5.

Chapter 5 — Scrutiny

5.1 Scrutiny Checklist

The Returning Officer shall scrutinise each nomination received using the checklist at Appendix C. The following items shall be verified for each nomination:

- The candidate is a Life Member of the Association.
- The proposer is a Life Member of the Association and is not the candidate.
- The seconder is a Life Member of the Association, is not the candidate, and has not proposed or seconded another candidate for the same post.
- The proposer and seconder have both confirmed their consent through the system.
- For nominations entered manually by the Returning Officer, the scanned nomination form signed by the candidate, proposer, and seconder has been uploaded to the election document store.
- The candidate satisfies the eligibility conditions for the specific post as described in Section 4.1.
- The tenure bars described in Section 4.1 do not apply to the candidate for the post sought.
- For Batch Representative posts, the candidate belongs to the batch group for which nomination is submitted.
- The nomination form is complete and in the prescribed format.
- The candidate is not contesting any other post in this election (one-post-per-person check).

All nominations, regardless of the phase or method through which they were submitted, are subject to the same scrutiny process before any candidate may appear on the ballot.

5.2 Query Procedure

Where the Returning Officer requires clarification on any aspect of a nomination, the Returning Officer shall send a written query to the candidate specifying the issue clearly and requiring a response within 48 hours. The query and the response received shall be retained as part of the election record. The election management system shall record the query and the date of issue in the ScrutinyLog automatically when the RO issues the query through the admin panel.

5.3 EC Referral

Where the Returning Officer requires clarification on a matter of EC tenure history or other institutional records that are not available through the election management system, the Returning Officer may refer the specific matter to the Executive Committee through the Refer to EC function in the admin panel. The referral triggers an automatic email to the designated EC contact with the query and a secure response link. The EC response is captured directly into the scrutiny record. All referrals, the date of referral, the EC response, and the date of response shall be recorded in the ScrutinyLog automatically. The Returning Officer's decision on the nomination remains final after considering the EC's response.

5.4 Acceptance and Automatic Candidate Entry

The Returning Officer shall communicate acceptance of a nomination to the candidate in writing through an automated email generated by the system at the point of acceptance.

Acceptance is a deliberate act by the Returning Officer, made through the admin panel scrutiny interface after all checklist items have been verified. The Returning Officer shall record a note in the scrutiny interface at the time of acceptance. The acceptance action and the note are written automatically and immediately to the ScrutinyLog tab by the system, creating a permanent timestamped record of the decision.

Upon the RO marking a nomination as accepted, the system shall automatically generate a candidate entry in the Candidates tab, drawing the candidate's name, roll number, batch,

post, bio, and photo from the nomination record. No manual transfer of nomination data to the candidate list is required or permitted. The auto-generated candidate entry is the operative record for ballot generation.

The candidate entry shall not be edited manually in the sheet. Any correction required after auto-generation shall be made by the RO Admin through the candidate management interface in the admin panel, and the correction shall be noted in the AdminLog.

5.5 Rejection

The Returning Officer shall communicate rejection of a nomination to the candidate in writing through an automated email generated by the system, stating the reasons with specificity. The rejection action and the reasons are written automatically and immediately to the ScrutinyLog tab by the system. A candidate whose nomination has been rejected may appeal to the Appeals Panel within 48 hours of receipt of the written rejection. The Appeals Panel shall decide the appeal within 48 hours. The voting window shall not open until all appeals against nomination rejections have been decided.

5.5A RO Correction and Reversal of Scrutiny Decisions

The Returning Officer may reverse any scrutiny decision — acceptance or rejection — at any time before the final candidate list is published. A reversal shall be made through the admin panel and shall be recorded in the ScrutinyLog with a timestamp and the reason for reversal. A reversal of an acceptance removes the auto-generated candidate entry. A reversal of a rejection reopens the nomination for reconsideration. No reversal is permitted after the final candidate list has been published.

5.6 Withdrawal During Scrutiny

A candidate may withdraw their nomination during the scrutiny period by written notice to the Returning Officer or through the My Nominations dashboard. The RO shall record the withdrawal in the admin panel, which writes the withdrawal automatically to the ScrutinyLog with a timestamp. A nomination withdrawn during scrutiny shall not appear on the ballot and the withdrawal may not be reversed.

5.7 Uncontested Posts

Where only one valid nomination is received for a post after the close of scrutiny, the candidate shall be declared elected without proceeding to a vote. The RO shall mark the post as uncontested in the admin panel. The declaration shall be communicated to all members along with the publication of the final candidate list.

5.8 No Nominations

Where no valid nomination is received for any post other than a mandatory post after the close of scrutiny, that post shall be declared vacant and shall be filled by co-option by the incoming Executive Committee in accordance with the Bylaws.

Where no valid nomination is received for any mandatory post — President, Vice President, General Secretary, or Treasurer — after all extensions under Section 4.9 are exhausted, the election shall not proceed. The matter shall be referred to the General Body for a decision. The election may proceed without a mandatory post being contested only upon approval of the General Body.

5.9 Final Candidate List

Upon completion of scrutiny, the Returning Officer shall publish the final list of candidates for each post. The list shall be auto-generated from accepted nominations in the system and shall be published to all members not less than three days before the opening of the voting window.

5.10 ScrutinyLog — Completeness Requirement

Every action taken by the Returning Officer during scrutiny — query issued, EC referral made, EC response received, query closed, nomination accepted, nomination rejected, nomination withdrawn — shall have a corresponding entry in the ScrutinyLog generated automatically by the system at the time of the action. No scrutiny action is complete until it is recorded in the log.

At the close of scrutiny, the Returning Officer shall review the ScrutinyLog to confirm that every nomination received has a final status entry — accepted, rejected, or withdrawn — and that no nomination is left in pending or query-issued status without resolution. The ScrutinyLog shall be exported and saved as part of the election record at the close of scrutiny.

Chapter 6 — Campaign and Code of Conduct

6.1 Permitted Campaign Activities

Candidates may communicate directly with individual members on a personal basis. Candidates may share their biography, credentials, and vision for their role with members through personal channels. Candidates may request individual members for support.

6.2 Prohibited Activities

The following activities are prohibited during the election period:

- Use of OBA mail groups, WhatsApp groups, or any other Association communication channel for election canvassing or campaign purposes. The election notice shall explicitly list the channels covered by this prohibition.
- Use of Association funds or resources for campaign purposes.
- Distribution of material, physical or electronic, through Association infrastructure for campaign purposes.
- Any act that could constitute undue influence, inducement, or intimidation in relation to any voter.
- Making or publishing false statements about any candidate.

6.3 Complaint Mechanism

Any member may submit a written complaint to the Returning Officer regarding a breach of the Code of Conduct during the election period. The complaint shall specify the act complained of with sufficient particularity. The Returning Officer is the first instance for all Code of Conduct complaints. The Returning Officer shall consider the complaint and communicate a decision in writing. A record of all complaints received and decisions taken shall form part of the election record.

6.4 Penalty and Appeals

The Returning Officer may impose such sanction as is proportionate to the breach, including a formal warning, removal of campaign material, or such other remedy as is available. Any candidate or member directly affected by a decision or sanction imposed under this section may file an appeal to the Appeals Panel. The decision of the Appeals Panel on such appeals shall be final for the purposes of the current election. Nothing in this section shall prejudice the right of any member to raise a governance grievance with the General Body after the election.

Chapter 7 — Voting

7.1 Mode of Voting

Voting shall be conducted in such mode as decided by the Executive Committee, preferably by electronic means to ensure wider participation. The mode of voting shall be independent of the mode of conduct of the Annual General Body Meeting. Where physical voting is used, the reasons shall be recorded and communicated to all members and placed before the next Annual General Body Meeting. Where physical voting is used it shall be by secret ballot.

The mode of voting refers only to the manner in which votes are cast and counted. The full procedure of elections — including the selection of the Returning Officer, nominations, scrutiny, and publication of the candidate list — shall be conducted as specified in this SOP regardless of the mode of voting. Each Life Member on the certified voter roll shall have one vote per post for which they are eligible. The secrecy and integrity of the ballot shall be preserved in all modes.

For electronic voting: the voting window shall open on the date specified by the Returning Officer and shall close at the date and time determined by the Returning Officer to allow results to be declared not less than 7 days before AGM day. Each voter shall be authenticated by Roll Number, registered email address, and one-time password.

For physical voting: voting shall take place on AGM day by secret ballot.

7.2 Ballot

The ballot shall show, for each post for which the voter is eligible, the list of candidates in randomised order. The voter may cast one vote per post. For multi-seat posts (Vice President and Joint Secretary) each voter shall have one vote; the top two vote-getters shall be elected.

The voter may also choose NOTA (None of the Above) for any post. The voter may choose to abstain from voting on any post, in which case no vote or NOTA is recorded for that post.

NOTA does not affect the outcome of the election — the candidate with the highest vote count is elected regardless of the NOTA count. For multi-seat posts, NOTA votes count against all candidates. The RO shall note the NOTA count for each post in the election record. A high NOTA count for any post may be recorded as an observation in the election record at the RO's discretion.

7.2A Multi-Seat Post — Counting Rule

For the post of Vice President, the two candidates receiving the highest number of votes shall be elected. For the post of Joint Secretary, the two candidates receiving the highest number of votes shall be elected. NOTA votes cast for a multi-seat post shall be counted and recorded separately; they do not affect the determination of the elected candidates. In the event of a tie for the final seat, the Returning Officer shall conduct a draw of lots in the presence of the Scrutineers. The result of the draw shall be final and binding.

7.3 Vote Anonymity

The election management system shall be designed such that the record of how a voter has voted cannot be connected to the identity of that voter. The system records two separate items when a vote is cast: the participation record, which identifies the voter and the post for which they voted but contains no vote content; and the vote record, which identifies the post and the candidate chosen but contains no voter identity. These two records are stored in separate tabs in the system with no common linking field. The structural separation means that no person — including the RO, the TEM, or any administrator of the system — can determine from the data how any individual voter voted. This design shall be demonstrated to the Scrutineers before the voting window opens and verified by them at the tally session.

7.4 Reminder Communications

The Returning Officer may cause reminder communications to be sent to voters who have not yet voted, at Day 3 and Day 6 of the voting window for electronic elections. Such communications shall not constitute canvassing and shall contain no reference to any candidate.

7.5 Assistance to Voters

Any voter who experiences difficulty authenticating or accessing the ballot during the voting window shall report the matter to the Returning Officer. The Technical Election Manager, on direction from the Returning Officer, shall be available to assist such voters. Assistance shall be limited to technical access issues and shall not extend to influencing the voter's choice in any way. All assistance requests and the actions taken in response shall be logged in the AdminLog automatically where the action is taken through the admin panel, and recorded in writing by the TEM where the action is taken outside the system, with a copy uploaded to the document store.

7.6 Technical Contingency and Continuity

In the event of a technical interruption of the voting platform during the voting window, the Returning Officer shall change the election status to paused through the admin panel. This transition is recorded automatically in the AdminLog. The Returning Officer shall cause a notification to be sent to all members that the voting window is temporarily suspended, stating that a technical review is underway.

The Returning Officer, with the assistance of the TEM where appointed, shall review the AdminLog and the Google account access log to determine the nature and extent of the interruption. The following staged response shall apply:

Stage 1 — Minor interruption: Where the interruption is a technical malfunction with no evidence of data compromise, the Returning Officer may restore the system and reopen the voting window after satisfying themselves that the system is functioning correctly. The voting window may be extended by the duration of the suspension and by not more than 48 hours in total without Executive Committee approval, to compensate voters who were unable to vote during the interruption. The extension and its reasons shall be recorded in the AdminLog.

Stage 2 — Extended interruption: Where the interruption cannot be resolved within 48 hours, the Returning Officer shall seek Executive Committee approval for a further extension. The Executive Committee shall respond within 24 hours. If extension is approved, the Returning Officer shall communicate the new voting window to all members. If extension is not approved, or if resolution is not possible, Stage 3 applies.

Stage 3 — Irrecoverable interruption or data compromise: Where there is evidence of tampering with the Votes or VotedLog tabs, or where the interruption cannot be resolved and the election cannot proceed in the given time period, the matter shall be placed before the General Body. The General Body shall decide whether to extend the election period or to conduct a fresh election. Where the election cannot be concluded by AGM day, the provisions of Section 2.5 shall apply.

All actions taken during and after a technical interruption shall be recorded in detail in the AdminLog and shall form part of the election record.

7.7 Closing the Poll

At the date and time declared by the Returning Officer in the published election schedule, the voting window shall be closed through the election management system. The closure is

recorded automatically in the AdminLog with a timestamp. No further votes shall be accepted after the poll is closed. The system shall not accept vote submissions once the election status is set to closed. The Returning Officer shall confirm the closure to the Scrutineers immediately.

7.8 Election Status Transitions — System Management

The election management system maintains the status of each election as one of the following values, in the sequence shown:

nominations_open → nominations_open_phase2 → scrutiny → candidates_published → active → paused → closed → declared

Each status transition is a deliberate act by the RO Admin through the admin panel. No status transition occurs automatically without RO Admin action. Each transition is recorded automatically in the AdminLog with the timestamp and the Admin ID of the person who performed it.

The following status transitions are the sole responsibility of the Returning Officer:

- nominations_open → nominations_open_phase2: triggered when Phase 2 opens at the close of Phase 1.
- nominations_open_phase2 → scrutiny: triggered at the close of the nomination window. Nomination submissions are no longer accepted.
- scrutiny → candidates_published: triggered when the Returning Officer has completed scrutiny and the final candidate list is ready for publication.
- candidates_published → active: triggered when the Returning Officer opens the voting window. The voting window shall not open while any mandatory post remains without an accepted nomination. The hard-block is lifted only where the Returning Officer has recorded a General Body approval authorising the election to proceed without that post. No discretionary Returning Officer override of the mandatory posts hard-block is available without a recorded General Body approval.
- active → paused: triggered if the Returning Officer suspends the voting window under Section 7.6.
- paused → active: triggered when the Returning Officer reopens the voting window after a suspension.
- active → closed: triggered at the close of the voting window. No further votes are accepted.
- closed → declared: triggered when the Returning Officer declares results after tally verification by Scrutineers.

7.9 Pre-Voting Window Verification

Before the voting window is opened — that is, before the status is changed from candidates_published to active — the Returning Officer must complete the Pre-Election Security Verification Checklist at Appendix H. Scrutineers must witness and confirm the items marked in that checklist as requiring their presence. The voting window shall not be opened until the checklist is completed and the Returning Officer's authorisation is recorded in the system. The completed checklist PDF shall be filed in the election record.

7.10 Voter Receipt Token

Upon casting their vote for each post, the voter receives a unique anonymous receipt token generated by the system. The token is a random alphanumeric string with no mathematical relationship to the voter's identity or to the content of their vote. It is displayed to the voter on screen after each vote is submitted and is also sent to the voter's registered email address.

After the declaration of results, a public token verification page shall be available on the election system. Any voter may enter their token and confirm that a vote was recorded from their session for that post. The verification confirms only that a vote exists in the system — it does not reveal the candidate chosen. Tokens are issued only for active ballot choices — a voter who chose Abstain for a post will not have a token for that post.

7.11 Observer Live Dashboard

Accredited Observers shall have access to a live participation dashboard during the voting window. The dashboard shows, in real time, the number of votes cast for each post. It does not reveal individual votes, voter identities, or the distribution of votes between candidates. Any Observer who believes the participation figures are irregular shall record their observation in writing and submit it to the Returning Officer immediately. A record of all Observer observations and Returning Officer responses shall form part of the election record.

7.12 Voter Support and Grievances During Voting Window

A voter who is unable to authenticate or access the ballot during the voting window shall contact the Returning Officer through the contact details published in the election notification. The Returning Officer may seek technical assistance from the TEM where required. All contacts and actions taken shall be logged in the AdminLog.

A voter who believes their vote has not been correctly recorded may raise a concern with the Returning Officer during the voting window. The Returning Officer shall investigate and respond in writing. The investigation shall not compromise ballot secrecy — the Returning Officer may confirm whether a participation record exists for the voter for the relevant post but shall not and cannot reveal how the voter voted.

No correction to a vote cast can be made after submission under any circumstance. A voter who submits their vote and subsequently wishes to change it has no recourse. This is a fundamental principle of any secret ballot.

Chapter 8 — Counting and Results

8.1 Tally Generation

After the close of the voting window, the Returning Officer shall generate the vote tally from the election management system. The tally shall show, for each post, the number of votes received by each candidate. The tally shall also show, for each post, the number of NOTA (None of the Above) votes recorded. NOTA votes are counted and displayed separately and do not affect the determination of the elected candidate.

8.2 Tally Verification

The Returning Officer, together with the Scrutineers, shall verify that the total number of votes recorded in the tally for each post equals the number of voters recorded as having participated for that post in the VotedLog. Any discrepancy shall be investigated by the Returning Officer before results are declared. The investigation and its outcome shall be recorded in writing.

8.3 Scrutineers' Sign-off

The Scrutineers shall review the tally for each post and, being satisfied as to its correctness, shall co-sign the tally through the system's tally co-sign function. The co-sign entry is recorded in the AdminLog with the Scrutineer's Admin ID and timestamp. Physical co-signature on a printed tally sheet is also permitted as a supplementary act. The co-signed tally shall form part of the election record.

8.4 Tie-breaking

In the event of a tie between two or more candidates for a post, the Returning Officer shall conduct a draw of lots in the presence of the Scrutineers, physically or remotely through a live video session. The method of the draw shall be determined by the Returning Officer. The result of the draw shall be final and binding and shall be recorded in the election record, noting the method used, the persons present, and the outcome.

8.5 Declaration of Results

For electronic elections: the Returning Officer shall declare the results not less than 7 days before the Annual General Body Meeting, after verification and Scrutineer sign-off. The declaration shall be communicated to all members immediately. Results shall be formally announced at the Annual General Body Meeting.

For physical elections: results shall be declared on AGM day after tally verification and Scrutineer sign-off.

Where the election concludes after AGM day: results shall be declared at the earliest practicable time and formally announced at such meeting as the Executive Committee convenes for the purpose.

For each post, the declaration shall state the name of the elected candidate. Vote counts shall be published as part of the election record.

8.6 Election Record

The Returning Officer shall compile and file with the incoming General Secretary, on the day the election period concludes, a complete election record comprising the following:

- Certified voter roll.
- Nomination forms received, with scrutiny notes and communications — including the full ScrutinyLog export.
- Final candidate list as published.
- Vote tally co-signed by the Scrutineers — system-generated PDF with AdminLog co-sign entries.
- Record of any draw of lots conducted.
- Declaration of results (Appendix F).

- Winners Summary (Appendix F2).
- List of Scrutineers and Observers with their participation records.
- AdminLog export — full log of all significant system actions with timestamps and Admin IDs.
- Pre-Election Security Verification Checklist — completed Appendix H pdf.
- Verification summary from the email verification exercise.
- Record of any Code of Conduct complaints received and decisions taken.
- Record of any technical interruptions and actions taken.
- Record of any Appeals Panel proceedings and decisions, including appeals received, decisions made, and reasons.

Chapter 9 — Remote and Hybrid AGM

9.1 Legal Basis

The Annual General Body Meeting may be held as a physical meeting, a virtual meeting, or in a hybrid format combining physical and virtual attendance. This is in accordance with Article IV of the Bylaws as amended at the Annual General Body Meeting held on 19 July 2025.

9.2 Platform

The Executive Committee shall designate the video conferencing platform for the Annual General Body Meeting. The platform shall support recording of proceedings, a participant list visible to the organisers, screen sharing for presentation of reports and results, and shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate the expected attendance.

9.3 AGM Attendance Registration

Attendance registration at the AGM is separate from election voting. Members shall register their attendance through such platform as designated by the Executive Committee for that purpose. Attendance registration gates access to resolution voting only and has no bearing on election voting, which is open to all Life Members on the certified voter roll during the specified voting window regardless of AGM attendance.

9.4 Quorum Verification

The quorum for the Annual General Body Meeting is 100 Life Members present and voting, in accordance with Article IV Section 3 of the Bylaws. For a remote AGM, the attendance register in the platform designated for that purpose shall be the record of presence. The AGM shall not be called to order until 100 Life Members have registered attendance.

9.5 Resolution Voting

Voting on resolutions at the AGM is conducted separately from election voting and is managed by the office bearers of the Association, not by the Returning Officer. Resolution voting is open only to members who have registered attendance at the AGM. Resolution voting is non-anonymous.

9.6 Election Results at AGM

For electronic elections, the Returning Officer shall have declared results not less than 7 days before the Annual General Body Meeting. At the AGM, the Returning Officer shall formally announce the results and the incoming Executive Committee shall take charge. Where the election concludes after AGM day, the formal announcement shall be made at such meeting as the Executive Committee convenes for the purpose, and the incoming Executive Committee shall take charge at that point.

9.7 Minutes

Minutes of the Annual General Body Meeting shall be recorded by the General Secretary. Draft minutes shall be circulated to all members within seven days of the meeting. The minutes shall be ratified at the next General Body Meeting of the Association.

Chapter 10 — Records and Archive

10.1 Records to be Retained

For each election, the following records shall be retained by the incoming General Secretary from the date the election period concludes:

- The complete election record filed by the Returning Officer as described in Section 8.6.
- The election schedule as published.
- Communications to members during the election period.
- The TEM Declaration of Impartiality (Appendix E1), where a TEM was appointed.
- The RO handover documentation (Appendix D).
- Scrutineer Declarations of Impartiality — system acceptance records (Appendix E2).
- Record of any Appeals Panel proceedings and decisions.

10.2 Retention Period

Election records shall be retained for a minimum of five years from the date of the relevant election. Records shall be stored in the Association's designated Google Drive folder under the custody of the General Secretary.

10.3 Access to Records

Any Life Member of the Association may submit a written request to the Executive Committee for access to the records of any election. The Executive Committee shall respond to such a request within 30 days. Access may be provided by sharing specific documents in read-only mode.

10.4 Handover to Incoming EC

The incoming General Secretary shall receive the complete election record from the Returning Officer on the day the election period concludes, as described in Section 8.6. The incoming General Secretary shall store all election records in the Association's designated Google Drive folder and shall hand them over to any subsequent General Secretary at the time of transfer of charge. Such handover shall be documented in writing and acknowledged by both parties.

APPENDICES

Appendix A — Model Election Calendar

All dates are expressed as days before V-day (the date of the Annual General Body Meeting). This calendar shall be adapted with actual dates for each election year and published to all members as part of the election schedule. The Returning Officer may allow longer periods at their discretion but shall not shorten the minimum periods specified in Chapter 1.

V-day is the date of the Annual General Body Meeting. All timelines are calculated from this date. The election process begins at V-47. Results are declared at V-7 for electronic elections. The formal announcement and EC handover take place on AGM day (V-0). Phase 1 and Phase 2 nominations run for 7 days each and are open for all posts unconditionally.

Reference	Event	Timing / Notes
V-47	Voter roll cutoff date	Not later than V-47
V-47	EC commences ascertaining willingness of eligible Life Members to serve as RO	Not later than V-47
V-45	Panel of fifteen senior-most willing eligible Life Members published to all members	Not later than V-45
V-40	Objection window on panel closes	5 days from panel publication
V-38	RO formally appointed; appointment communicated to all members	Within 2 days of close of objection window
V-38	Appeals Panel constituted by Executive Committee	Simultaneously with RO appointment communication
V-38	TEM appointment, where made, communicated to all members	Simultaneously with or within 2 days of RO appointment. Where no TEM appointed, RO records declaration in AdminLog — no member communication required.
V-38	Nomination call issued by RO	On or shortly after RO appointment
V-38	Draft voter roll handed to RO by office bearers	On or before nomination call
V-35	TEM objection window closes (where TEM appointed)	3 days from TEM appointment communication
V-33	Draft voter roll published to all members; objection window opens	Not later than V-33
V-31	Phase 1 nominations close	7 days from nomination call
V-31	Phase 2 nominations open (all posts — unconditional)	Immediately upon Phase 1 close
V-26	Voter roll objection window closes	7 days from publication
V-24	Phase 2 nominations close / nomination window closes	Not later than V-24 (minimum 14 days from nomination call)
V-24	RO certifies final voter roll	Not later than V-24
V-19	Scrutiny closes	Not later than V-19 (minimum 5 days)
V-19	Final candidate list published to all members	Not later than V-19; not less than 3 days before voting window opens

V-18	Candidature withdrawal deadline	End of day D+1 from candidate list publication
V-16	Voting window opens	Not earlier than 72 hours after candidate list publication
V-9	Voting window closes	Not later than V-9 — to allow tally and Scrutineer verification before V-7
V-7	Tally verification by RO and Scrutineers; results declared	Not later than V-7 (electronic elections). Results declared to all members immediately.
V-0	AGM day — formal announcement of results; Executive Committee handover	V-day. RO files complete election record and surrenders credentials to incoming EC on the day the election period concludes.

Where any phase is extended under Section 1.5, all subsequent dates shift accordingly. Stage compression is available under Section 1.5 subject to minimum floors. The RO shall communicate any revised schedule to all members immediately. AGM notice to all members — minimum 14 days per Article IV Section 2 of the Bylaws — is the responsibility of the General Secretary and runs in parallel with the election schedule. For extended elections where the voting window cannot close by AGM day, the provisions of Section 2.5 apply. V-0 remains AGM day; the election period extends beyond it.

Appendix B — Nomination Form Template

SSKZM OBA — Nomination Form for Executive Committee Elections

Election Year: _____

Post for which nomination is submitted: _____

Candidate Details

Full Name: _____ Roll No: _____ Batch: _____

Email Address: _____ Phone: _____

Eligibility Declaration

I hereby declare that:

- I am a Life Member of SSKZM OBA.
- I satisfy the eligibility conditions for the post of _____ as specified in the election notification.
- The tenure bars described in the election notification do not apply to me for this post.
- I am not contesting any other post in this election.

Signature / Electronic Confirmation of Candidate: _____ Date: _____

Proposer Details

Full Name: _____ Roll No: _____ Batch: _____

I am a Life Member of SSKZM OBA and I propose the above candidate for the post of _____.

Signature / Electronic Confirmation of Proposer: _____ Date: _____

Secunder Details

Full Name: _____ Roll No: _____ Batch: _____

I am a Life Member of SSKZM OBA and I second the above nomination.

Signature / Electronic Confirmation of Secunder: _____ Date: _____

Appendix C — Scrutiny Checklist

The Returning Officer shall verify each of the following for every nomination received:

1. The candidate is a Life Member of the Association. Yes / No
2. The proposer is a Life Member of the Association and is not the candidate. Yes / No
3. The seconder is a Life Member of the Association, is not the candidate, and has not proposed or seconded another candidate for the same post. Yes / No
4. The proposer and seconder have both confirmed their consent through the system. Yes / No
5. For nominations entered manually by the Returning Officer, the scanned nomination form signed by the candidate, proposer, and seconder has been uploaded to the election document store. Yes / No / Not applicable
6. The candidate satisfies the eligibility conditions for the specific post as described in the election notification. Yes / No
7. The tenure bars do not apply to the candidate for the post sought. Yes / No
8. For Batch Representative posts, the candidate belongs to the batch group for which the nomination is submitted. Yes / No / Not applicable
9. The nomination form is complete and in the prescribed format. Yes / No
10. The candidate is not contesting any other post in this election (one-post-per-person check). Yes / No

Appendix D — RO Handover Checklist

D.1 — Handover to Returning Officer

Items to be handed over by the Executive Committee to the Returning Officer on the date of formal appointment. Handover may be completed by authenticated email with digital acknowledgement.

- Certified voter roll (or draft voter roll if certification is pending) — handed over: Yes / No — Date: _____
- Election schedule as published — handed over: Yes / No
- Login credentials for the election management application — handed over: Yes / No
- Name and contact details of the prospective TEM, if already identified — handed over: Yes / No / Not yet identified
- Names and contact details of Scrutineers appointed by the Executive Committee, and confirmation of their acceptance — handed over: Yes / No
- Record of TEM appointment or non-appointment declaration — handed over: Yes / No
- Contact details of the General Secretary for liaison — handed over: Yes / No

Handed over by (General Secretary): _____ Date: _____

Received by (Returning Officer): _____ Date: _____

D.2 — Handover from Returning Officer

Items to be filed with the incoming General Secretary by the Returning Officer on the day the election period concludes, being the day the incoming Executive Committee takes charge:

- Certified voter roll — filed: Yes / No
- All nomination forms received with scrutiny notes — filed: Yes / No
- Final candidate list as published — filed: Yes / No
- Vote tally co-signed by Scrutineers (system PDF) — filed: Yes / No
- Record of any draw of lots — filed: Yes / No / Not applicable
- Declaration of results (Appendix F) — filed: Yes / No
- Winners Summary (Appendix F2) — filed: Yes / No
- List of Scrutineers and Observers — filed: Yes / No
- AdminLog export — filed: Yes / No
- Pre-Election Security Verification Checklist (Appendix H PDF) — filed: Yes / No
- Verification summary from email verification exercise — filed: Yes / No
- Record of Code of Conduct complaints and decisions — filed: Yes / No
- Record of any technical interruptions and actions taken — filed: Yes / No / Not applicable
- Record of any Appeals Panel proceedings and decisions — filed: Yes / No / Not applicable
- TEM Declaration of Impartiality (Appendix E1), where a TEM was appointed — filed: Yes / No / Not applicable
- Scrutineer Declarations of Impartiality (Appendix E2) — system acceptance records — filed: Yes / No

Filed by (Returning Officer): _____ Date: _____

Received by (incoming General Secretary): _____ Date: _____

Appendix E — Declarations of Impartiality

Appendix E1 — Declaration of Impartiality (Technical Election Manager)

Where a Technical Election Manager has been appointed.

SSKZM OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION — Declaration of Impartiality and Absence of Conflict of Interest (Technical Election Manager)

I, _____, Roll No _____, Batch _____, hereby declare as follows:

- I am not contesting any post in the Executive Committee elections for the year _____.
- I am not a member of the current Executive Committee of SSKZM OBA.
- I shall carry out the duties assigned to me as Technical Election Manager with impartiality and in accordance with the instructions of the Returning Officer.
- I understand that my role is technical and that all decisions relating to the conduct of the election vest in the Returning Officer.

Signed: _____ Roll No: _____ Date: _____

Witnessed by (Returning Officer): _____ Date: _____

Appendix E2 — Declaration of Impartiality (Scrutineers)

Constituted by the Scrutineer's digital acceptance through the election management system. The system acceptance record in the AdminLog is the operative record. A physical form is not required but may be provided additionally.

SSKZM OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION — Declaration of Impartiality (Scrutineer)

I, _____, Roll No _____, Batch _____, hereby declare as follows:

- I am not contesting any post in the Executive Committee elections for the year _____.
- I am not a member of the current Executive Committee of SSKZM OBA.
- I shall carry out the duties assigned to me as Scrutineer with impartiality.
- I acknowledge that my acceptance through the election management system constitutes this declaration.

Digital acceptance recorded in AdminLog: Yes — Timestamp: _____

Physical signature (optional supplementary): _____ Date: _____

Appendix F — Results Declaration

Appendix F — Declaration of Election Results

SSKZM OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION — Declaration of Election Results

Election Year: _____

I, _____, Returning Officer for the SSKZM OBA Executive Committee Elections
_____, hereby declare the following results:

Contested Posts — Vote Count

[Complete the table below for each contested post. Repeat candidate rows as needed for each post.]

Post	Candidate	Votes Received	NOTA	Total Votes Cast	Result
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	Elected / Not elected
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	Elected / Not elected
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	Elected / Not elected

Uncontested Posts

The following posts were uncontested; candidates declared elected without a vote:

Post: _____ Candidate: _____

[Repeat for each uncontested post]

Vacant Posts

The following posts received no nominations and are declared vacant:

Post: _____

Participation Summary

Total voters on certified roll: _____

Total voters who participated: _____

Turnout: _____

Scrutineer Co-Signatures

1. _____ Signature / System Co-sign: _____

2. _____ Signature / System Co-sign: _____

3. _____ Signature / System Co-sign: _____

Date and Time of Declaration: _____

Signed (Returning Officer): _____ Date: _____

Appendix F2 — Winners Summary

SSKZM OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION — Executive Committee Election Results Summary

Election Year: _____

Date of Declaration: _____

Post	Member Elected
President	_____
Vice President 1	_____
Vice President 2	_____
General Secretary	_____
Joint Secretary 1	_____
Joint Secretary 2	_____
Organising Secretary	_____
Treasurer	_____
Batch Representative — [Batch Group]	_____
[Additional posts as applicable]	_____

Certified by (Returning Officer): _____ Date: _____

Appendix G — Glossary

AGM: Annual General Body Meeting of the SSKZM Old Boys Association, held once every year.

AdminLog: The append-only audit log in the election management system recording all significant admin actions with timestamp and Admin ID.

Batch Group: A defined range of five consecutive batch years for the purpose of Batch Representative elections.

EC: Executive Committee of SSKZM OBA.

Election Period: The period commencing on the date of the Returning Officer's formal appointment and concluding on the day the incoming Executive Committee takes charge. The Returning Officer shall file the complete election record with the incoming General Secretary on that day. The Returning Officer's authority shall continue for the full duration of the election period.

GBM: General Body Meeting. Includes the Annual General Body Meeting and Special General Body Meetings.

Life Member: A member of the Association who has paid the prescribed Life Membership fee. Only Life Members are entitled to vote in Executive Committee elections.

Minimum Required Posts List: The list of EC posts configured by the RO per election for which at least one accepted nomination must be received before the voting window may open. The mandatory posts — President, Vice President, General Secretary, and Treasurer — are always on this list and may not be removed.

Phase 1 Nominations: Nominations submitted directly by the candidate with proposer and seconder confirmation, during the first seven days of the nomination window.

Phase 2 Nominations: Nominations submitted by any member on behalf of any candidate, with candidate consent required, during the second seven days of the nomination window. Phase 2 is open for all posts unconditionally.

RO: Returning Officer. The constitutional authority for the conduct of elections.

ScrutinyLog: The append-only audit log in the election management system recording all RO actions during the scrutiny process.

SOP: Standard Operating Procedure.

TEM: Technical Election Manager. The person appointed by the Returning Officer, if deemed necessary, to assist in operating the election management application. The TEM acts solely under the direction and authorisation of the Returning Officer.

Tenure: A continuous period of service on the Executive Committee.

V-day: The date of the Annual General Body Meeting. All election timeline dates in this SOP are expressed relative to V-day.

VotedLog: The record within the election management system of which voters have participated in an election. The VotedLog contains no information about how any voter has voted. It is structurally separated from the Votes record to preserve ballot secrecy.

Votes: The record within the election management system of all votes cast. The Votes tab contains no voter identity information. It is structurally separated from the VotedLog to preserve ballot secrecy.

Appendix H — Pre-Election Security Verification Checklist

To be completed before the voting window is opened for any live election. All completions are recorded automatically in the AdminLog with timestamp and Admin ID.

Election: _____ Election Year: _____ Video session date and time: _____

Participants — RO: _____ TEM: _____ Scrutineer 1: _____
Scrutineer 2: _____

Part A — Sheet Protection ★

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
A1 ★	OTPs tab is protected and hidden — demonstrated by RO/TEM attempting to open tab directly and confirming it is not visible	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
A2 ★	Votes tab is protected read-only — demonstrated by RO/TEM attempting to edit a cell and confirming protection prevents it	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
A3 ★	VotedLog tab is protected read-only — demonstrated as above	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
A4 ★	Voters tab is protected read-only after voter roll certification — demonstrated as above	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
A5 ★	Admins tab is protected against direct sheet editing — demonstrated as above	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
A6 ★	AdminLog tab is protected append-only — demonstrated by RO/TEM attempting to edit an existing row and confirming protection prevents it	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —

Scrutineers confirm Part A: Scrutineer 1: _____ System confirmation timestamp: _____
Scrutineer 2: _____ System confirmation timestamp: _____

Part B — Script and Deployment ★

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
B1 ★	Deployed Apps Script version number opened in deployment manager on screen share and recorded in election record	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
B2 ★	Deployed version confirmed against published open-source repository version or commit hash	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
B3 ★	No redeployment since version recorded in B1 — confirmed by RO	Confirmed	RO: _____ —

Scrutineers confirm Part B: Scrutineer 1: _____ System confirmation timestamp: _____
 Scrutineer 2: _____ System confirmation timestamp: _____

Part C — Google Account Security

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
C1	2-Step Verification confirmed active on elections.sskzmoba@gmail.com tied to OBA official phone — shown on screen share	Confirmed	RO/TEM: _____ —
C2	Recovery email (sskzmobakazak@gmail.com) confirmed functional — test email sent and received	Confirmed	RO/TEM: _____ —
C3	Google account access log reviewed — no unrecognised access since last review	Confirmed	RO/TEM: _____ —
C4	Account password was changed by RO at EC handover and not shared with any EC member	Confirmed	RO: _____ —

Part D — Voter Roll and Candidate List

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
D1	Voter roll certified by RO and uploaded — row count in system matches signed certification	Confirmed	RO/TEM: _____ —
D2	Candidate list complete — all posts have accepted candidate, uncontested declaration, or vacant post declaration	Confirmed	RO: _____ —
D3	Mandatory posts — President, Vice President, General Secretary, and Treasurer — all have accepted nominations on the final candidate list. If not, the voting window shall not open. Where the General Body has authorised proceeding without a mandatory post, the Returning Officer	Confirmed	RO: _____ —

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
	has recorded the General Body approval in the admin panel		
D4	OrgSecyRestricted setting confirmed correct in election configuration	Confirmed	RO/TEM: _____ —

Part E — System Functionality Testing

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
E1	Pre-election test vote cast — confirmed not in live tally — test data cleared	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
E2	OTP delivery confirmed functional — test OTP sent and received	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
E3	Session expiry confirmed functional	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
E4	Ballot eligibility filtering confirmed — Batch Rep posts visible to correct batches only	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
E5	Voter receipt token confirmed generated and delivered on test vote	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
E6	Nomination submission confirmed blocked once status is candidates_published or later	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —

Part F — Backup

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
F1	Voters tab export saved to GDrive election folder	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
F2	Elections tab export saved to GDrive election folder	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
F3	Candidates tab export saved to GDrive election folder	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
F4	ScrutinyLog export saved to GDrive election folder	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
F5	AdminLog export to date saved to GDrive election folder	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —

Part G — Communications

Item	Verification Required	Status	Verified by
G1	Final candidate list published to all members	Done / Not Done	RO: _____ —
G2	Voting window notification sent to all voters with authentication instructions and RO contact	Done / Not Done	RO: _____ —
G3	Observer accreditation confirmed — dashboard access given to all accredited Observers	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —
G4	Scrutineer read-only access to Google Sheet confirmed active	Done / Not Done	RO/TEM: _____ —

Final Authorisation

I, _____, Returning Officer, hereby confirm that all items in this checklist have been completed to my satisfaction and that the election management system is ready for the voting window to be opened.

Signed (Returning Officer): _____ Admin ID: _____ Date and Time: _____

Witnessed by Scrutineer 1: _____ Date: _____

Witnessed by Scrutineer 2: _____ Date: _____

SSKZM OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION

BYLAWS – ARTICLE IV SECTION 1A

Proposed Sub Section (iii) - Elections

Preamble

The existing sub-section (iii) of Article IV Section 1A of the Bylaws of SSKZM OBA reads as follows:

"The senior-most Old Boy present (by batch / roll no.) during the AGBM on Old Boys' day shall be the Returning Officer and shall conduct the elections of all the Office bearers at the Annual General Body Meeting. The President shall assist in conducting the election if the Returning Officer requests help, provided he is not seeking re-election. If it so happens that the President is the senior-most Old Boy, then the senior-most Old Boy (other than the EC members) present during the Annual General Body Meeting shall conduct the election. The Returning Officer shall be an Old Boy who is not standing for the elections."

The above sub-section is replaced in its entirety by the following principle-based elections clause comprising sub-clauses (a) through (n). Sub-sections (iv), (v), and (vi) of Article IV — governing candidate eligibility for President and General Secretary and the tenure bar — are unchanged and remain in force.

Clause (a) — Returning Officer

The Executive Committee shall, sufficiently in advance of the Annual General Body Meeting, ascertain the willingness of Life Members in order of seniority to serve as Returning Officer and publish a panel for member objection. The senior-most willing eligible member against whom no valid objection stands shall be appointed Returning Officer. The Executive Committee shall continue this process down the order of seniority until the role is filled. The procedure for selection, objection, and appointment shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (b) — Deputy Returning Officer

The Returning Officer may designate a Deputy Returning Officer from the panel published for the purpose of RO selection. The Deputy Returning Officer may be activated only upon the Returning Officer's confirmed unavailability and shall operate under the same authority and constraints as the Returning Officer for the duration of activation. The Deputy Returning Officer shall satisfy the same eligibility conditions as the Returning Officer. Every office of the Deputy Returning Officer shall be honorary. The procedure for designation, activation, and operation shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (c) — Technical Election Manager

The Returning Officer may, if deemed necessary, appoint a Technical Election Manager to assist in the administration of the election management system. The Technical Election Manager shall act solely under the direction and authorisation of the Returning Officer and shall have no independent constitutional authority over the conduct of the election. The Technical Election Manager shall preferably be a Life Member of the Association. Every office of the Technical Election Manager shall be honorary where the appointee is a Life Member. The procedure for appointment and operation shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (d) — Scrutineers and Observers

The Executive Committee shall appoint not less than two Scrutineers to witness and verify the election process. Scrutineers shall be Life Members of the Association who are not contesting any post and are not members of the current Executive Committee. The Returning Officer may accredit Observers for the election, who may include representatives nominated by contesting candidates. Observers shall have access to aggregate participation data only and shall have no access to individual voter information or vote data. The duties of

Scrutineers and Observers and the procedure for their appointment shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (e) — Voter Roll

Only Life Members of the Association as on a cutoff date determined by the Executive Committee shall be entitled to vote in Executive Committee elections. The office bearers shall prepare a draft voter roll and hand it to the Returning Officer. The Returning Officer shall publish the draft voter roll for member objection, consider all objections received, and certify the final voter roll before the voting window opens. No additions, deletions, or corrections shall be made to the certified voter roll after certification under any circumstance. The procedure for preparation, publication, objection, and certification shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (f) — Nominations

The Returning Officer shall issue a notification calling for nominations to all posts of the Executive Committee. Each nomination shall require the confirmation of a proposer and a seconder, both of whom shall be Life Members of the Association. A candidate may not be their own proposer or seconder. Nominations shall be submitted through such means as designated by the Returning Officer, which shall include provision for online submission. The procedure for nomination, including timelines, forms, and confirmation requirements, shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (g) — Scrutiny

The Returning Officer shall scrutinise each nomination received and verify the eligibility of the candidate for the post sought. The Returning Officer may seek clarification from any candidate or from the Executive Committee on matters of institutional record. The Returning Officer shall communicate the acceptance or rejection of each nomination to the candidate concerned, with written reasons in the case of rejection. Upon completion of scrutiny, the Returning Officer shall publish the final list of candidates for each post. The procedure for scrutiny, including timelines, query procedure, withdrawal, and publication, shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (h) — Appeals Panel

The Executive Committee shall constitute an Appeals Panel drawn from the panel published for RO selection. The Appeals Panel shall hear appeals against nomination rejections and against decisions or sanctions imposed in the conduct of the election. Any candidate or member directly affected by a decision or sanction imposed under these rules may file an appeal to the Appeals Panel. The decision of the Appeals Panel shall be final for the purposes of the current election. Nothing in this clause shall prejudice the right of any member to raise a governance grievance with the General Body. The procedure for constitution, appeal, and decision shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (i) — Uncontested Posts

Where only one valid nomination is received for a post, the candidate shall be declared elected without proceeding to a vote.

Where no valid nomination is received for any of the posts of President, Vice President (at least one), General Secretary, and Treasurer after the nominations process is concluded, the election shall not proceed, and the matter shall be placed before the General Body for a decision. The election may proceed without a mandatory post being contested only upon approval of the General Body. Where no valid nomination is received for any other post, that

post shall remain vacant and shall be filled by co-option by the incoming Executive Committee in accordance with the Bylaws.

Clause (j) — Voting

Voting shall be conducted in such mode as decided by the Executive Committee, preferably by electronic means to ensure wider participation. The mode of voting shall be independent of the mode of conduct of the Annual General Body Meeting. Where physical voting is used, the reasons shall be recorded and communicated to all members and placed before the next Annual General Body Meeting. Where physical voting is used it shall be by secret ballot. The mode of voting refers only to the manner in which votes are cast and counted. The full procedure of elections — including the selection of the Returning Officer, nominations, scrutiny, and publication of the candidate list — shall be conducted as specified in this clause and in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time, regardless of the mode of voting. Each Life Member on the certified voter roll shall have one vote per post for which they are eligible. The secrecy and integrity of the ballot shall be preserved in all modes. The procedure for voting, including authentication, voting window, and closing of poll, shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (k) — Results

Upon the close of voting, the Returning Officer, together with the Scrutineers, shall verify the count and certify the results. The Returning Officer shall declare the results at the earliest practicable time after verification and shall formally announce them at the Annual General Body Meeting where results have been declared prior to the AGM, or at such other meeting convened by the Executive Committee for the purpose where the election concludes after AGM day. In the event of a tie between two or more candidates for a post, the Returning Officer shall conduct a draw of lots in the presence of the Scrutineers, and the result of the draw shall be final. The Returning Officer shall compile a complete election record and file it with the incoming General Secretary on the day the election period concludes. The procedure for verification, declaration, and filing shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (l) — Candidate Eligibility

Candidate eligibility for each post shall be as specified in sub-sections (iv), (v), and (vi) of this Article, which shall apply equally regardless of the mode of voting. The detailed eligibility criteria and scrutiny procedure shall be as specified in the Operating Procedures laid down from time to time.

Clause (m) — Caretaker Executive Committee

Where the election cannot be concluded by the date of the Annual General Body Meeting, the outgoing Executive Committee shall continue in a caretaker capacity with powers as determined by the General Body at the Annual General Body Meeting, until the incoming Executive Committee takes charge on conclusion of the election which shall be at the earliest practicable time at a meeting convened by the outgoing Executive Committee for the purpose.

Clause (n) — Operating Procedures

The Executive Committee shall frame Operating Procedures for the conduct of elections consistent with this clause. Such Operating Procedures shall be placed before the Annual General Body Meeting for ratification. The Executive Committee may amend the Operating Procedures from time to time consistent with the Bylaws.